

Daniel Short

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DATA SCIENTIST | MACHINE LEARNING

Data analyst specializing in tourism and destination marketing analytics, with experience translating complex datasets into actionable insights for stakeholders, marketing strategy, demand forecasting, visitor insights, economic impact, stakeholder reporting, and campaign performance.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Reporting & BI** - Tableau, Dashboards, KPI Development, Stakeholder Reporting, Campaign Performance, Marketing Analytics
- **Data & Analytics** - SQL, Excel, Python, Pandas, Demand Forecasting, Visitor Insights, Destination Marketing, Economic Impact
- **Machine Learning** - PyTorch, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLP, Autoencoders / VAEs
- **Generative AI** - LLMs, RAG, LoRA Fine-Tuning, Embeddings, Transformers

WORK EXPERIENCE

Business Analyst Visit Grand Junction	February 2024 – Present Grand Junction, CO
• Automated Industry Data Reports and stakeholder reporting, saving 200+ hours annually and cutting turnaround 99%. • Authored semimonthly council and stakeholder updates using tourism, lodging, and web-performance data. • Identified lodging cannibalization by reconciling tax records with occupancy, ADR, and RevPAR, shaping council updates and strategy. • Researched traveler trends and AI search behavior to guide content and GEO strategy, contributing to +9.4% organic sessions and 10x AI referrals YoY.	
AI Data Quality Analyst Randall Reilly	November 2023 – January 2024 Remote
• Re-platformed R workflows into a one-click Python app, cutting delivery time by 95%. • Built decision-tree models that expanded serial-number tracking by over 10x while flagging anomalies with 98% precision. • Deployed an autoencoder model that lifted overall data quality for downstream analytics.	
Asset Protection Data Analyst Target	June 2022 – November 2023 Montrose, CO
• Designed dashboards that boosted theft reporting by 57.6% and increased prevention 180%. • Reduced inventory loss by 24% through analytics-driven investigations and tooling. • Presented actionable insights to non-technical stakeholders across multiple teams.	

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

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| • M.S. Data Science , Eastern University - GPA: 4.0/4.0 | May 2025 |
| • B.S. Data Analytics , Purdue University Global - GPA: 3.6/4.0 | May 2023 |

[IBM Data Analyst](#), [IBM Machine Learning](#), [Google Analytics](#), [Google Data Analytics](#), [Google Advanced Data Analytics](#)

PROJECTS

- [Sheet Music Watermark Removal](#) - Built an ML pipeline to remove watermarks and upscale sheet music.
- [Synthetic Digit Generator](#) - Developed a VAE to learn and generate MNIST digit representations.
- [Nonogram Solver](#) - Created a reinforcement-learning model to solve Nonogram games (94% solve rate).
- [Chatbot \(LoRA + RAG\)](#) - Fine-tuned a Mistral model with LoRA and FAISS-backed RAG to deliver cited answers via Gradio.